

STAGE TWELVE • LEADERSHIP

FIRSTS

DISCUSSION PROMPTS

Open-ended questions to seed group conversation beyond the worksheets

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Discussion Prompts

Stage Twelve • Leadership

PURPOSE

Individual worksheets answer “what's your leadership style, your decision, your philosophy?” These prompts answer a different question: “what's your real, lived experience of leading and being led?” They're open-ended and personal, meant to seed conversation beyond a simple share-out of worksheet answers.

Use these during share-out portions, when a session finishes its planned agenda with time to spare, or when a group's energy needs a genuine, specific prompt rather than “any volunteers?” They're organized by session, four prompts each.

Many of these prompts work just as well drawing on experiences of being led by someone else as they do on participants' own leadership experience — useful for cohorts still early in their own leadership journey.

Prompts by Session

SESSION 1

Leadership Foundations

"Has someone with no formal authority over you ever led you more effectively than someone who did?"

"What's a leadership responsibility you've avoided taking on, and what held you back?"

"Think of a team you were part of with a genuinely unclear goal — what happened as a result?"

"Has a leader's vision ever actually changed how you felt about a task, beyond just what you were told to do?"

SESSION 2

Leading & Developing People

"What's the hardest leadership decision you've ever had to make, and what made it hard?"

"Has anyone ever coached you toward your own answer instead of just telling you what to do? How did that feel compared to being told?"

"Describe feedback you received that was delivered so gently the actual point got lost. What would have made it land better?"

"Have you ever avoided a difficult conversation as long as possible? What eventually happened?"

SESSION 3

Advanced & Reflective Leadership

"Has working across two different teams or functions ever revealed a real translation gap you hadn't expected?"

"Think of a moment someone stayed calm during a genuine crisis. What specifically did they do?"

"What's stopped you from asking for honest feedback about your own leadership, if anything has?"

"Looking back across this whole stage, what's one principle you'd want to guide how you lead, even years from now?"